

Mushroom walnut roast

Walnuts, tofu, and oats make for a familiar yet **distinctive** taste that resembles a traditional meatloaf. Like meatloaf, this tastes great hot or cold. Serve with mashed potatoes and a vegetable and top with Chipotle Mushroom Ragout (page 220) or Rustic Creamy Tomato Sauce (page 226).

3 tablespoons olive oil

1 large onion, finely chopped

3 garlic cloves, minced

½ cup coarsely chopped walnuts, toasted
[50g]

½ cup rolled oats (regular or instant) [50g]

¼ pound fresh shiitake mushrooms,
stemmed, caps thinly sliced [125g]

About 2 cups vegetable stock or water
[500ml]

1 tablespoon soy sauce

3 tablespoons Dijon mustard

2 tablespoons tomato paste

2 tablespoons red wine or red wine vinegar

1 tablespoon vegetarian Worcestershire
sauce

Salt and freshly ground pepper

1 pound firm tofu, pressed of excess water,
crumbled [500g]

3 tablespoons arrowroot

1 to 1½ cups dried whole wheat or white
bread crumbs [100 to 140g]

1. **Preheat** the oven to 350°F [175°C]. In a large nonstick skillet, heat half the olive oil over medium heat. Add the onion and cook, stirring occasionally, until soft and golden brown, 7 to 10 minutes. Add the garlic and cook for 1 to 2 minutes longer, until fragrant. Set aside in large bowl.
2. In the same skillet, **heat** the remaining oil over medium heat. Add the walnuts, oats, and mushrooms. Sauté for a few minutes, stirring frequently, until the mushrooms are tender. Add a splash of stock or water if the ingredients stick too much.
3. **Stir** in a small amount of stock, turn up the heat, and deglaze the pan (deglazing means loosening stuck-on bits of the good stuff with a hot liquid). Add the remaining stock and cook for 10 minutes. Add the soy sauce, mustard, tomato paste, red wine, and hot sauce. Continue to cook until the mixture is thick, 2 to 3 minutes. Add to the bowl with the onions and set aside. Season generously with salt and pepper to taste.

4. Add the tofu and arrowroot to a food processor; **puree** until smooth. Add to the onion mixture and blend in enough bread crumbs to make a thick paste; mix well. Pour into a nonstick or lightly oiled loaf pan measuring 9 by 5 by 3 inches [about 23 by 12 by 8cm]. Press down firmly to pack the mixture into the pan.
5. **Bake** for 40 minutes. For optimal results, let the loaf cool for 2 hours before slicing it, or make a day ahead and reheat.

SERVES 6 TO 8

chef's tip

For a perfect crispy top, place an additional pan of water in the oven while you bake the loaf.